

Tasting

Being able to taste food increases our enjoyment of eating. It also warns us not to eat food that may be harmful. Sensors in the tongue can detect five tastes—sweet, sour, salty, bitter, and umami (savory).

Tongue and taste buds

When food enters the mouth, the muscular tongue moves the food around and mixes it with saliva. At the same time, 10,000 taste buds in the tongue's upper surface detect the tastes in the food and send that information to the brain.

